

Tools tip: You can use the 'strace' command in Linux to generate logs which you can use for your investigation or for taking professional help. The command tracks a program and all its activities.

Were there any changes made in the system between the time from when it was fine to now, when it has a problem?

This is very important as more often than not, issues are caused by changes made in the system, whether in the software or the hardware. Hence, taking this into consideration should be an important part of your investigation. It is a good idea to take a look at system logs for this as they can point out the changes made to a system.

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MAN(1)                                Manual pager utils                                MAN(1)

NAME
    man - an interface to the on-line reference manuals

SYNOPSIS
    man [-c|-w|-tZ] [-H[browser]] [-T[device]] [-adhu7V] [-i|-I] [-m sys-
    tem[,...]] [-L locale] [-p string] [-C file] [-M path] [-P pager] [-r
    prompt] [-S list] [-e extension] [section] page ...] ...
    man -l [-7] [-tZ] [-H[browser]] [-T[device]] [-p string] [-P pager] [-r
    prompt] file ...
    man -k [apropos options] regex ...
    man -f [whatis options] page ...

DESCRIPTION
    man is the system's manual pager. Each page argument given to man is
    normally the name of a program, utility or function. The manual page
    associated with each of these arguments is then found and displayed. A
    section, if provided, will direct man to look only in that section of
    the manual. The default action is to search in all of the available
    sections, following a pre-defined order and to show only the first page
    found, even if page exists in several sections.

    The table below shows the section numbers of the manual followed by the
    Manual page man(1) line 1
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The 'man' command displays documentation for Linux components

What are the effects of the problem?

Next, you must investigate all the effects being caused by the problem. Do the effects point to any specific hardware or software? How is the problem manifesting? Through visual, sound, etc. effects? If you have a basic understanding of the hardware and software of your system, you will be able to narrow down the possible causes.

Tool tip: The 'man' command is very useful as it displays the documentation for a Linux component whether it is a program, utility or function. When you go